

Are you currently supporting any family members financially?

Professional Assistance

Do you have a lawyer? What is his/her name?

What is the contact information for your lawyer?

Do I have your permission to contact your lawyer?

Do you have an accountant? What is his/her name?

What is the contact information for your accountant?

Do I have your permission to contact your accountant?

Do you have a financial advisor? What is his/her name?

Do I have your permission to contact your financial advisor?

What is the contact information for your financial advisor?

If you think asking your partner to complete a Relationship Due Diligence checklist is an egregious insult, you may want to reconsider tying the knot. All the dirty laundry is going to come out the minute you apply for a loan or buy a house together—and certainly if you adopt a child—so you’re going to be filling out questionnaires far more intrusive than this one. It’s better to surface any potential issues now, *before* the lawyers get involved.

When Linda and I got married, we had very few assets. I was just getting my business off the ground and I had some stocks I wanted to protect, but that was about it. But even we had many candid discussions about how we wanted to structure our lives. We both knew we wanted a family, and Linda was a self-professed “family girl.” She made it clear she wasn’t a career woman, and we both knew I was a career man. So we agreed on a clear division of labor that made sense. Now, when we look back on our marriage contract, we laugh. Twenty-four years ago, we walked through our separate apartments and assigned dollar values to everything we owned as part of our financial audit and contract. “This sofa is worth \$300. That table is worth \$150.” We hardly owned anything of value! For us, the marriage contract was a kind of pre-prenup—a way to protect the assets we *would* accumulate in the future. We grew into